

Chapter 169-5

Xu Qingzhu leaned there and said, "Before today, I didn't feel this strongly about it. I would have thought it was something I could take or leave. But thinking about it carefully today, it seems like I've gained a kind of strength over the past six months. I know I have people to protect, and people protecting me. Like... my mom. I know that if there's anyone in this world who would give unconditionally for me, she would definitely be the first."

As Xu Qingzhu spoke, her eyes welled up with tears and her voice became somewhat choked. "See, I haven't actually spent much time with her properly, but she can give me this sense of security. That's really important to me. I feel like I'm not afraid of anything anymore. Even if... I mean, just in case, even if one day our relationship really came to an end, I wouldn't feel like my existence in this world is meaningless, because they are also part of the meaning of my existence."

Liang Shi's hands on the steering wheel were trembling.

The car had just arrived downstairs, but neither of them moved. The lights inside the car were still on.

Xu Qingzhu looked at her. "I was thinking, if only someone could give you this same sense of security. If only someone could love you like this too. Not just me alone loving you, not just me alone giving you this confidence."

A tear suddenly fell from Liang Shi's eye.

She closed her eyes and opened them again, then reached out to pat Xu Qingzhu's head. "Why so sentimental?"

Xu Qingzhu chuckled softly. "Actually, I'm really afraid that if one day I'm gone, what would you do if you couldn't go on living? So I want you to have bonds with more people. That way, even in days without me, you can still shine."

Liang Shi: "..."

"What nonsense are you saying?" Liang Shi pinched her face. "You're going to live to a hundred years old with me."

Xu Qingzhu unbuckled her seatbelt and nodded. "Okay."

When they got out of the car, Liang Shi suddenly said, "Then I'll give it a try."

Xu Qingzhu smiled and nodded at her.

"What if she doesn't want to acknowledge me?" Liang Shi asked. "Or what if it's like with Guo Xinran—she got her parents' love, but was rejected by her siblings. What then?"

Xu Qingzhu paused, then walked firmly to Liang Shi's side. "Please, you're my Teacher Liang. Who wouldn't like you? Guo Xinran was like that because she was restless and wanted too much. We don't want anything. Are we short on money?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She could hear a sense of wealth and confidence in those words.

Xu Qingzhu said, "We're not short on money. If they are, we can even lend them some. But I also have a selfish motive."

"What?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu held her hand, swinging it gently back and forth in the air. "If we find them first, the initiative and the choice are in our hands. How can you be sure your parents aren't looking for you? Rather than letting the unexpected come knocking, we might as well turn the unexpected into the expected."

Liang Shi: "..."

Her perspective had been opened up.

After a long while, Liang Shi said, "I was abandoned outside Shi'an Hospital, in a near-death state."